

>> That Extra Zing

Zalman Real Surround Sound Headphones Theatre 6

A heady thud

The Zalman 5.1 headphones are deceptively light, and the earpads are especially comfortable. There are three connectors for 5.1 sound—the front, centre and rear channels. The connectors are 1/8-inch stereo jacks.

Sound-quality is decent. The immersive experience is something you simply can't get with stereo headphones. Do these headphones really sound like 5.1 speakers? Yes, and no. Though you do get dimensionality and perspective, especially when watching a movie, it's not like you're immersed in sound. Don't even think of them as substitutes for 5.1 speakers.

Treble quality is mediocre, and you'll need to pump it up. The mids and bass are okay, although the bass can't be called tight. It doesn't crack at high bass, but doesn't deliver the punch either. They miss out totally on high trebles and really deep bass. Classical music listeners will be disappointed. It's a mixed story for gamers. Though airplanes do seem to whizz from left to right and front to back, the effect isn't good enough, period. A more expensive version would probably deliver the goods.

These phones are worth the price if you're not expecting audiophile-quality sound, and you're content with the spectrum being chopped off at the ends. What these phones are ideally suited for are action movies. Do remember to use the equaliser, though.

Specifications: 50 Hz - 20 KHz frequency response, 89 db sound level, 0.15 W max power, 316.8 gms weight, three headphone jacks, 300 cm long cord ■ **Price:** Rs 2,995 ■ **Contact:** Mediatech India ■ **Phone:** 022-26361111 ■ **E-mail:** info@mediatechindia.com ■ **Web site:** www.zalman.co.kr ■ **Overall Rating:** ★★★★★

Control your Remotes

Home theaters have hit the Indian entertainment market, and they're here to stay. Very soon, you're going to be stuck with more remote controllers than you can manage—for your TV, DVD, receiver, speaker set, etc. This is where a true programmable, universal remote comes in. One unit that you can control all your gadgets with, and not sacrifice on functionality. Universal remotes are programmable and can be made to learn the signals of even the most obscure features. So, you can finally do away with the heap of remotes.

The universal remote (marked with a red

circle) has a button that allows you to choose the device to control. In order to program the universal remote, you need to place the device's remote and the universal remote with their IR sensors facing each other. Now, you press the Learn key on the universal remote, then the button you want to define, followed by the corresponding key on the device's remote. An indicator on the universal remote lights up to tell you that the signal has been received. Repeat this procedure for all the keys of the device's remote that you want the universal remote to learn, and you're done.

You can even get advanced universal remotes that boast of an LCD display and better programming features, to make life easier.

